That is the only known surviving record of her at Covent Garden Theatre, but she must have been there much longer than the 1760–61 season. Her presumed husband, the wardrobe keeper Robert Whitfield, was at the theatre for at least four or five years. And the author of George Anne Bellamy's *Apology* makes Miss Bellamy testify that "Mrs. Whitfield, the daughter of Nurse Carter," was "my dresser for some years." Evidently Mrs Whitfield was in good circumstances and an influential member of the theatrical community, for when Mrs Bellamy was in debt, Mrs Whitfield "came with a deputation from Mr. Hull and Mr. Mattocks, offering their joint endeavours to raise a sum, in order to extricate me from the debts which oppressed me." Miss Bellamy happily accepted. Later, Mrs Whitfield raised further sums to aid the struggling (and extravagant) Miss Bellamy.

It is probable that the actor John Whitfield, who made his Covent Garden debut in 1774, was the son of Mr and Mrs Robert Whitfield.

Whiting, Thomas *[fl. 1659–1662], joiner.*

Thomas Whiting (or Whitein), a joiner, helped prepare pageants for the Lord Mayor's shows in the fall of 1659, 1660, and 1662. In 1661 he worked on the coronation entertainments.

Whitlock, Mrs Charles Edward, Elizabeth, née Kemble *1761–1836, actress.*

Elizabeth Kemble was born at Warrington, Lancashire, on 2 April 1761, the fifth child and third daughter of the provincial actors Roger and Sarah (née Ward) Kemble. Information about the family background may be found in the notice of her father, the progenitor of a very large and important theatrical dynasty.

Like her elder brothers and sisters, Elizabeth began her theatrical apprenticeship at a very young age, playing children's roles in the touring company managed by her parents. A surviving playbill for a performance of *King Charles the First* at Worcester on 12 February 1767 records the youngsters at work in the family enterprise, despite the legend that Roger Kemble was anxious that none of his children should take up the profession. In that



Courtesy of the Garrick Club

ELIZABETH WHITLOCK
attributed to Beach

production mother and father acted General and Lady Fairfax, brother John Philip Kemble played James, Duke of York, sister Sarah (later the illustrious Mrs Siddons) portrayed Princess Elizabeth, and sister Frances was the young Duke of Gloucester. Elizabeth, then age seven, seems not to have performed that night, though no doubt she would join the others onstage before long. Her name is on the bill for a performance of *The Constant Couple* at Carmarthen, Wales, on 20 September 1776, when at the age of 15 she acted Parly.

According to early memoirs, Elizabeth Kemble was apprenticed to a mantua maker, but if she was it must have been for a brief period. In the National Library of Scotland is an untitled manuscript of 14 quatrains of bad verse on how to play the card game ombre, dated "Monmouth, April 1780" and signed Elizabeth Kemble. By that time she was 19 and probably an experienced stroller. In the summers 1781 and 1782 she acted at York and early in the winter of 1783 ventured to



Courtesy of the Garrick Club

ELIZABETH WHITLOCK, as Margaret
by De Wilde

London in hopes of repeating her sister Sarah's great success, something her other elder sister Frances Kemble had failed to do when she made her debut at Drury Lane as Alicia in *Jane Shore* on 6 January 1783.

Elizabeth came out at Drury Lane on 22 February 1783 as Portia in *The Merchant of Venice,* a role she repeated on 1 March. A press clipping in the Enthoven Collection (misdated by hand 15 February 1783) reported, "She does not promise to be that successful acquisition to the Theatre which the Managers have found in her sister Sarah, nor did she seem calculated for the serious part of the Character she performed." Time might make her a "tolerable actress," the critic concluded, but "at present, although she merits encouragement, she is not entitled to applause." On 4 March 1783 the theatre treasury paid her ten guineas. Within a week she had found her way to York, where on 10 March she acted Selima in *Tamerlane* for Wilkinson, who described her in his *Wandering Patentee* as being at that time "possessed of great marks of merit, though wild as a colt untamed," in the fullness of youth, health, and spirit.

Despite Elizabeth's inauspicious debut, she was reengaged at Drury Lane for two more seasons, no doubt through Mrs Siddons's influence. Indeed, in *The Children of Thespis,* Anthony Pasquin (John Williams) severely criticized the nepotism at Drury Lane:

> *Amazing! a third! lo, here Kemble again.*
> *With* Kembles *on* Kembles *they've chok'd*
> *Drury-lane;*
> . . . . . .
> *But cash is the magnet that draws them from*
> *far,*
> *'Tis the god of their race, and their grand polar*
> *star. . . .*

In 1783–84 Elizabeth acted Rosalind in *As You Like It,* Mariana in *Edward the Black Prince,* Margaret in *A New Way to Pay Old Debts,* Imogen in *Cymbeline,* Leonora in *The Revenge,* Portia again, and Elvira in *Love Makes a Man.* In 1784–85 she added Lucia in *Cato,* Lady Touchwood in *The Double Dealer,* Marwood in *The Way of the World,* and Rutland in *The Earl of Essex.* A benefit she shared with her sister Frances on 23 April 1785 brought net receipts of about £90. During this period in London she rented lodgings in the house of the actor and playwright Thomas Holcroft in Southampton Buildings.



Harvard Theatre Collection

ELIZABETH WHITLOCK (when Miss Kemble), as Imogen

artist unknown

At Lancaster on 21 June 1785 Elizabeth Kemble married Charles Edward Whitlock, a manager of the theatres at Chester, Newcastle, Sunderland, and Lancaster, and a sometime dentist. In 1780 he had succeeded Heatton as Austin's partner on that circuit, a very extensive one that also included Whitehaven and Preston and required some 1100 miles of travel each year. When Austin retired, Munden became Whitlock's partner until he grew tired of management and sold out to the latter. In 1791 Whitlock sold his interest in the circuit for £1000, according to Winston's *Theatric Tourist,* to his brother-in-law Stephen Kemble. From 1785 until 1791 Mrs Whitlock was one of the chief ornaments of the circuit, especially at Chester and Newcastle.

With her husband, Mrs Whitlock played for Wilkinson at York in May 1792, acting

capital roles such as Jane Shore and for her benefit on 16 May speaking an epilogue on the different humours of French, Italian, Dutch, and English husbands. Though she possessed merit, Wilkinson thought she at times fell into "a dull seeming mediocrity." He proclaimed her, however, "a great treasure for a country theatre, and would be so for a London one, provided she pays more regard to an uniformity of acting and character." A notation made by Austin on a playbill now at the Folger Shakespeare Library reveals that Mrs Whitlock "could not keep her temper."

Mrs Whitlock's opportunity to return to London came only a few weeks after her York engagement, when she was brought to the Haymarket early in the summer season to substitute for her sister-in-law, Mrs Stephen Kemble, whose arrival had been delayed. On 18 June 1792 Elizabeth appeared as Queen Margaret in *The Battle of Hexham* and on 23 June Julia in *The Surrender of Calais*. Mrs Kemble replaced her in the latter role on 6 July. Though she had not been given much of a trial in her brief stay at the Haymarket, the press noticed that her improvement since her last appearance some six years previous had been "*astonishingly great*." The inevitable comparison to Sarah Siddons was made:

> though she does not interest the feelings so powerfully in *pathetic* description, or the more *tender* parts of tragedy, she falls not far behind the excellence of her sister, Mrs. Siddons, in the energy and spirit of *declamation*.—HER delivery of the Speech of Julia, at the throne of Edward, in the last scene of the Surrender of Calais, was a grand and interesting evidence of her knowledge in the principles of action and elocution; the former, was majestic and judicious, and the latter, forcible and captivating.

In 1793 the Edinburgh manageress Mrs Esten engaged the Whitlocks for the Theatre Royal in Shakespeare Square. She made her debut as Elwina and he as Earl Raby in *Percy* on 12 January. By the end of the season that April Mrs Whitlock had acted at Edinburgh at least 19 first-line roles, including Alicia in *Jane Shore*, Belvidera in *Venice Preserv'd*, Imogen in *Cymbeline* (with Whitlock as Pisanio), Juliet in *Romeo and Juliet*, Lady Macbeth (with Whitlock as Macduff), Lady Randolph in *Douglas* (with him as Lord Randolph), Mrs Beverly in *The Gamester*, and Portia in *The Merchant of Venice*.

During their stint at Edinburgh (and Glasgow), Thomas Wignell saw the Whitlocks and engaged them for his new Chestnut Street Theatre at Philadelphia. According to T. Allston Brown, Mrs Whitlock made her first American appearance at Annapolis, Maryland, where the Philadelphia company had sought refuge from a yellow fever epidemic that prevented their moving into their new home. The Chestnut Street Theatre finally opened on 18 February 1794, and the next night the Whitlocks appeared as Isabella and Count Baldwin in *Isabella; or, The Fatal Marriage*. After three seasons at Philadelphia they were briefly at Charleston, South Carolina, early in 1796 when she acted Miss Hardcastle in *She Stoops to Conquer* on 25 January and Lady Teazle in *The School for Scandal* in April, among other roles.

In the fall of 1796 the Whitlocks joined Hodgkinson's company at the Federal Street in Boston, then returned for the winter to Charleston, when that city saw her as Belvidera, Imogen, Lady Teazle, and Euphrasia in *The Grecian Daughter*. Her New York debut was on August 1797 at the Greenwich Street Theatre as Isabella. She made her debut at Providence in the same character on 4 July 1798 and then returned to Boston's Federal Street Theatre for 1798–99 and 1799–1800. In November 1798 their combined weekly salary was $37.33, the same as that of Hodgkinson and his wife. Whitlock's benefit receipts that season (recorded in a manuscript in the Boston Public Library) were $174.50 and his wife's a much larger $388.75. In the summer of 1800 Whitlock took over that theatre, went to England to recruit players, and upon his return began his Federal Street management on 27 October 1800. Notable was his production of *Pizarro*, with scenes painted by Bromley of Drury Lane, with original music, the first time that popular piece was seen in Boston. Despite *Pizarro*'s long and successful run, Whitlock lost $4000 for the season and gave up the house. In 1802–3 they played again at Philadelphia and at the Park Theatre in New York.

Until the arrival of Mrs Merry in the New World, Mrs Whitlock was distinguished, ac-



Harvard Theatre Collection

Said to be ELIZABETH WHITLOCK as Lady Teazle, Joseph Tayler as Joseph Surface, John Hodgkinson as Charles Surface, and Joseph Jefferson as Sir Peter Teazle

by Dunlap

cording to Bernard, as "the American Siddons." "Her defects were her person, which was short and undignified, and her heavy, thick voice," Bernard wrote in his *Retrospections of America,* "but she had the family face and a genuine passion, which could kindle the sympathies and blind the spectator to every deficiency." Bernard praised her as "an honor to her profession in every sense, and was happy in a husband who partook all her worth, and some amount of her powers." In similar glowing terms William Dunlap described Mrs Whitlock as "a fine looking woman" whose "eye and voice were powerful" in the Siddons tradition: "She was of great value in her profession, and out of it an honour to her family."

The Whitlocks seem to have remained in America for several more years. Their son, Henry E. Whitlock, who was born in 1787, made his stage debut at Boston as Young Norval in *Douglas* in 1803–4. The critics declared him, in Clapp's words, "a rough diamond who wants the assistance of a lapidary." The young actor's death in the Isle of France was reported by the Boston *Columbian Centinel* on 22 November 1806.

Elizabeth Whitlock and her husband returned to London about 1807, the year in which her mother died. Presumably she then received her equal interest—of the two renters' shares in Drury Lane Theatre that had been left to her and her siblings Sarah, John, Stephen, and Charles in 1803 (but to be passed along only after the death of his wife) by their father Roger Kemble. On 6 October 1807 at Drury Lane, where she had not performed for 22 years, she acted Elwina. She seems not to have performed there again.

Her activities are unknown to us until she returned to Philadelphia in October 1812. She then played in Boston eight nights before the year was out. In July 1813 she was engaged four nights in Providence, playing Lady Macbeth, Catherine (in *Catherine and Petruchio*) and Elvira. By March 1814 she was again in Philadelphia. The American critics noticed a marked improvement since her previous visit, but she had grown very corpulent.

She settled eventually with her husband at Addlestone, near Chertsey, in Surrey, where Charles Edward Whitlock died on 3 March 1822. (His death in America had been erroneously reported years earlier by the *Gentleman's Magazine* of May 1799, but the following month that journal made a retraction.) Though he had never been seen on the London stage, he was credited by Wilkinson with "much merit as an actor, equally so for a gentleman of integrity." His will, signed on 29 May 1821 and proved at London by his widow on 18 July 1822, described him as a gentleman formerly of Charleston, South Carolina, but then of Addlestone.

Elizabeth Whitlock died 14 years later, on 27 February 1836, at almost 75, at Addlestone. She also had a residence in Mortimer Street, Cavendish Square, London. In her will signed on 21 December 1832, when she resided in Clapham Road, she left her copyhold cottage, orchard, and garden at Addlestone to Maria Theresa Kemble, wife of her brother Charles Kemble for her use, rent-free, for the rest of her life, and then to Maria's children. The portrait of herself by Opie she left to Charles, and some clothes, watches, and trinkets she gave to her sister Jane Mason, actress-wife of actor Henry Mason. The residue of her estate, which included annuities totaling about £778, shares in Philadelphia Insurance and Globe Insurance, and furniture, she bequeathed to her three nieces Frances Ann, Amelia, and Elizabeth, the single daughters of her sister Frances Twiss. In a codicil dated 18 October 1835, necessitated by the death of Jane Mason in 1833, she gave her late sister's legacy to the three Twiss daughters and added a new bequest of income from £1300 in 3½% annuities, alloting £600 to her nephew Horace Twiss and £700 to her sister Ann Hatton of Swansea for her life and after Ann's death to Elizabeth's niece Jane Mason.

The will was proved on 14 March 1836 by Horace Twiss and Charles Kemble, to whom administration was granted. No children of her own were mentioned in the will. Her son, the actor Henry E. Whitlock, as noted above, had died in 1806. Two other sons, one born on 30 March 1786 and baptized John Kemble Whitlock at St Andrew's Church, Newcastle, on 20 April 1836, and the other, name unknown, born at Newcastle on 4 March 1792, were also dead by 1832.

Elizabeth Whitlock was anatomized in an unsympathetic description provided by her niece Fanny Kemble (daughter of Maria Theresa and Charles Kemble) in her *Records of a Girlhood* (1878):

> She was a very worthy but exceedingly ridiculous woman, in whom the strong peculiarities of her family were so exaggerated, that she really seemed like a living caricature of all the Kembles. She was a larger and taller woman than Mrs Siddons, and had a fine, commanding figure at the time I am speaking of, when she was quite an elderly person. She was like her brother Stephen in face, with handsome features, too large and strongly marked for a woman, light grey eyes, and a light auburn wig, which, I presume, represented the colour of her previous hair, and which, together with the tall cap that surmounted it, was always more or less on one side. She had the deep, sonorous voice and extremely distinct utterance of her family, and an extraordinary vehemence of gesture and expression quite unlike their quiet dignity and reserve of manner, and which made her conversation like that of people in old plays and novels; for she would slap her thigh in emphatic enforcement of her statements (which were apt to be upon an incredibly large scale), not unfrequently prefacing them with the exclamation, 'I declare to God!' or 'I wish I may die!' all which seemed to us very extraordinary, and combined with her large size

and loud voice used occasionally to cause us some dismay.

Sarah Siddons more kindly described her sister as "a noble, glorious creature, very wild and eccentric." The divine Sarah's biographer Thomas Campbell said that Elizabeth was "just what Mrs Siddons would have been if she had swallowed a bottle of champagne."

Portraits of Elizabeth Whitlock include:

1. Attributed to Thomas Beach. Canvas 29¼" × 24½", head and shoulders in profile to left, facing viewer; broad-brimmed hat with white ostrich plume. In the Garrick Club (No 414). Provenance unknown.

2. By John Opie. In her will Elizabeth Whitlock left a portrait of herself by Opie to her brother Charles Kemble. The present location of the portrait is unknown.

3. By unknown artist. Miniature (4¼" high) in metal-gilt ropework frame. Three-quarter face to left, body profile to left, in white dress and black hat with ostrich feathers. Sold at Christie's on 15 April 1958 (lot 44); bought for 32 guineas by Schidlof. This miniature seems to be a copy of the canvas in the Garrick Club (see No 1 above).

4. As Imogene in *Cymbeline*. By unknown engraver. Full-length profile, left hand upraised. Incorrectly listed in the Hall *Catalogue of Engraved Dramatic Portraits* in the Harvard Theatre Collection as Frances Twiss, Mrs Whitlock's sister.

5. As Lady Teazle, with Joseph Taylor as Joseph Surface, John Hodgkinson as Charles Surface, and Joseph Jefferson as Sir Peter Teazle, in *The School for Scandal*. Painting by William Dunlap. In the Harvard Theatre Collection, a gift from R. G. Shaw, 1922.

6. As Margaret in *The Earl of Warwick*. By S. De Wilde. In the Garrick Club (No 450), from the Mathews collection. In the Thomas Harris sale on 12 July 1819 (lot 62). Engraving by P. Audinet; published as a plate to *Bell's British Library*, 1792.

Whitlow. *See* WHITTOW.

Whitmeal, Sylvester *[fl. 1660–1679], trumpeter.*

The trumpeter Sylvester Whitmeal was appointed to the King's Musick on 11 June 1660, yet a Lord Chamberlain's warrant dated 13 November 1661 appointed him again but as a trumpeter extraordinary—that is, without fee. It is not clear when he was given a salaried post, but when he accompanied Charles II to Bath in 1663 he received 5*s*. daily extra pay. His basic salary was £60 annually. He was last mentioned in the accounts on 13 December 1679.

Whitmell, Mr *[fl. 1786–1803], actor, singer, dancer.*

Mr Whitmell (sometimes Whitmill or Witmill) was a ballet and specialty dancer, occasional singer, and minor actor in London's winter patent theatres and summer circuses from 1786 or earlier until at least the 1802–3 season. He was advertised as a "principal dancer" at the Royal Circus in 1786 and 1787. His first recorded appearances at a patent theatre were as one of the Men Milliners in the new pantomime *Harlequin's Chaplet* at Covent Garden in five performances, 1 March 1790 and following.

In the 1790–91 season he transferred his services to Drury Lane and remained with that company at least until past the end of the century. On 25 July 1792 and throughout August following, he danced at the Haymarket in the chorus of *The Enchanted Wood*. A Master Whitmell, doubtless a son, was also present. On the following 27 December at Drury Lane a Miss Whitmell was among the dancers.

Whitmell's other named parts were Masaniello in *Don Juan* in 1791–92; a Pirate in *The Pirates* in 1792–93; a Vintager in *The Pirates* in 1793–94; one of the Horde in *Lodoiska* and an Indian Warrior in *The Cherokees* in 1794–95; a Gardener in *Harlequin Captive* in 1795–96; a Principal Savage in *Robinson Crusoe* in 1796–97; a Male Slave in *Blue-Beard* in 1797–98; a Vassal in *Feudal Times* and Ralph in *Catherine and Petruchio* in 1798–99; and Tamuri in *Lodoiska* in 1799–1800. He was often featured in entr'acte turns. In the season of 1802–3 his salary was £1 5*s*. per week.

Whitmell, Master *[fl. 1792] dancer.* *See* WHITMELL, MR.

Whitmell, Miss *[fl. 1792] dancer.* *See* WHITMELL, MR.